

Unit 1 Religion and Life Based on a Study of Christianity and at Least One Other Religion

Content overview

This unit requires students to study the relationship between religion and life in the UK. There are four sections covering believing in God, matters of life and death, marriage and the family, and religion and community cohesion.

Students are required to base their studies on Christianity and at least ONE, but no more than TWO, of the following religions: Buddhism, Hinduism, Islam, Judaism, Sikhism. However, Section 1 is based on a study of one religion only.

Key words are given at the beginning of each section. Students should be aware of their meanings and be able to use them in their examination answers. A glossary of the key words can be found in *Appendix 4*.

In order to meet Assessment Objective 2, students need to be aware of a range of responses addressing religious and/or non-religious beliefs.

Assessment overview

Assessment will be through a one-and-a-half-hour examination. The examination will be divided into four sections and students will be expected to choose one of the two questions set on each section, ie four questions in total. Each question is sub-divided into four parts structured on an incline of difficulty.

Religious Studies papers are designed to give access to the full range of grades and are not tiered.

Quality of Written Communication will be assessed through Assessment Objective 1 in part c) of each question.

Detailed unit content

Section 1.1 Believing in God

This section is based on a study of one religion only.

Students will be required to: demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specification; express their own responses to the issues and questions raised by the specification using reasons and evidence; evaluate alternative points of view about these issues and questions.

Key words — agnosticism, atheism, conversion, free will, miracle, moral evil, natural evil, numinous, omni-benevolent, omnipotent, omniscient, prayer

- The main features of a religious upbringing in one religion and how it may lead to belief in God.
- How religious experiences, as seen in the numinous, conversion, miracles and prayer, may lead to belief in God.
- The argument from design and how it may, or may not, lead to belief in God.
- The argument from causation and how it may, or may not, lead to belief in God.
- Why scientific explanations of the origins of the world may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to scientific explanations of the origins of the world.
- Why unanswered prayers may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to the problem of unanswered prayers.
- Why evil and suffering may lead some people not to believe in God.
- How one religion responds to the problem of evil and suffering.
- How two television and/or radio programmes and/or films about religion may affect a person's attitude to belief in God.